PAVEL CHERKASHIN

Academy Partnerships Lead • Global Affairs • Partner Portfolio & Ops Automation

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Operating Thesis: *"Empowering grassroots builders, educational institutions, and civil society worldwide through accessible frontier AI. Scaling OpenAI Academy partner programs—from high-energy Academy Jams to train-the-trainer Community Trainer cohorts—while building automated operational infrastructure (intake pipelines, API credit allocation, impact telemetry, and curriculum distribution) that multiplies partner impact without administrative bloat."*

STRATEGIC FOCUS: GLOBAL AFFAIRS & SCALABLE ACADEMY ECOSYSTEMS

OpenAI Academy serves as a cornerstone of OpenAI's Global Affairs mission: democratizing access to frontier intelligence by investing directly in developers, educators, and organizations solving local challenges in low- and middle-income regions. Sustainable ecosystem expansion requires more than transactional credit grants; it demands an end-to-end partner operating framework. As a published university textbook author, mentor to 5,000+ founders and students, former regional technology executive across Eastern Europe/CIS, and builder of autonomous agent swarms, I bridge high-level policy objectives with rigorous operational execution. I translate institutional partnerships into vibrant community-led builder ecosystems that advance economic opportunity, educational equity, and responsible AI adoption.

THE 6-MONTH PARTNER OPS AUTOMATION ARC (OPERATIONAL PRIORITIES & MILESTONES)

Months 1–2 **Architecture & Onboarding**	**Partner Portfolio Blueprint & Automated Intake:** Map partner tiers across universities, NGOs, and developer collectives. Establish automated partner onboarding pipelines: application triage, API credit allocation, verification (KYA/sanctions compliance), and kickoff cadences. Launch initial pilot series of localized Academy Jams with regional university partners.
Months 3–4 **Community Trainers & Scale**	**Community Trainer Program & Mentorship Mesh:** Roll out standardized train-the-trainer cohorts to empower local professors, tech hubs, and NGO leads. Implement mentorship-matching workflows connecting OpenAI research/engineering volunteers with partner initiatives. Deliver multi-regional Academy Jams supporting grassroots problem-solving.
Months 5–6 **Telemetry & Product Loops**	**Partner Impact Telemetry & Codified Playbooks:** Deploy real-time partner dashboards tracking project completion, developer engagement, and local economic impact. Synthesize partner learnings directly into OpenAI product roadmaps and Global Affairs policy briefings. Hand off automated operational playbooks to regional teams for self-driving scale.

CORE PARTNERSHIP & OPERATIONAL CAPABILITIES

- **End-to-End Partner Lifecycle:** Managing institutional relationships from discovery to contracting, program launch, impact measurement, and long-term cohort expansion.
- **Community Trainer Scaling:** Author of university curricula; experienced in designing train-the-trainer frameworks that empower local educators to scale knowledge exponentially.
- **Academy Jams & Hackathons:** Designed and hosted dozens of hands-on builder hackathons, developer showcases, and sprint competitions across international ecosystems.
- **Partner Ops Automation:** Architect of autonomous multi-agent pipelines; automating credit distribution, partner milestone telemetry, and regulatory compliance reporting.

SELECTED CAREER TRACK RECORD & INSTITUTIONAL LEADERSHIP

Managing Partner & Ecosystem Architect — *Mindrock Capital / Vestor.In* (2016–Present)
- Orchestrated strategic partnerships and deployed $100M+ across frontier technology ventures. Architected AI-native operational automation systems that slashed administrative friction for international partner networks.

Author & Educator — *Venture Capital & Entrepreneurship University Textbook*
- Authored authoritative, voice-driven university textbook utilized in business schools across Eastern Europe. Designed experiential pedagogy and case studies empowering students, educators, and first-time founders.

Investment Lead & Mentor — *Founder Institute Alumnus (2014) & Decile Start Fund*
- Conducted 5,000+ deep-dive founder and educator evaluations; structured regional accelerator pipelines in San Francisco bridging global emerging market talent with Silicon Valley resources and mentors.

Regional Country Manager & Director — *Enterprise Technology & Regional Operations*
- Led regional market operations across Russia & CIS; negotiated collaborative programs with university computer science departments, government innovation agencies, and national developer communities.

EDUCATION, GLOBAL ECOSYSTEMS & CREDENTIALS

- **Quantitative Foundation & Systems:** Applied Mathematics & Computer Science, Russian State University of Oil & Gas.
- **Global Accelerator Alumnus & Ecosystem:** Founder Institute (Silicon Valley Alumnus, 2014) & Decile Start Fund Investment Lead.
- **Languages & Cross-Cultural Reach:** Fluent English, native Russian; deep educator, policymaker, and builder relationships across US, Europe, and Asia.